

Client Evaluation

Proposal: Data-Driven Publishing Strategy for Steam Game Releases

Criterion:

Answered Problem Sections, 5/5

The analysis addressed my main questions in my proposal. It investigated whether genre and price were associated with the commercial success of game releases, and it tested whether other pre-release characteristics could improve predictions, finally it compared these findings to determine which publishing strategy was best. The final recommendation from the report was to use multiple pre-release characteristics rather than relying only on genre or premium pricing.

Technique judgment, 5/5

The analysis compared different supervised classification models, including a genre-only model, a full logistic regression model, and a Random Forest. I think this was a good approach because commercial success was defined as a binary outcome, and comparing the simpler genre model against models using more pre-release information directly tested whether the data-driven strategy provided additional value.

Evaluation/interpretation quality, 5/5

The models were evaluated using ROC-AUC, precision, recall, and F1, which was useful because successful games made up a relatively small portion of the dataset. The results were also connected back to the success criteria by comparing how well the genre-only and full models could identify successful games. I also liked that the final model was recommended as a screening tool rather than something that should automatically approve or reject games. My main concern is that success was defined using 50,000 estimated owners, meaning older games had more time to reach that threshold than newer games.

Communication, 4/5

The report was generally understandable and did a good job of explaining the results in terms of the client's publishing decisions rather than only presenting model metrics. The final recommendations clearly explained that genre alone was not enough, identified which pre-release characteristics were associated with success, and clarified that the model should be used as a screening tool rather than a tool to automatically approve or reject games. The report

also did a good job of explaining the thought process and problem solving throughout the analysis. However, it could have benefited from better formatting and clearer section headers, such as a dedicated model comparison section and a clearer separation between the EDA and modeling sections.

Overall, I thought the analysis did a good job of answering my proposal and turning the results into useful recommendations that a real company could utilize. The finding I found most useful was the identification of specific pre-release characteristics associated with commercial success. In particular, broader language support, availability on more platforms, and certain genres were associated with higher success, while self-published, Casual, and Early Access games tended to perform worse.